

How does it work?

AMP, which is a framework to create mobile web pages includes three basic parts:

(1) AMP HTML – This markup language is a subset of HTML. It has a few properties and custom tags as well as quite a few restrictions.

However, if you are familiar with regular HTML, adapting the existing pages to AMP HTML won't be a big deal. You can learn more about the differences between AMP HTML and regular HTML by looking into the list of required markup for AMP projects that you can find online.

(2) AMP JS – This is a JavaScript framework for mobile pages. It mostly manages resource handling and asynchronous loading. Do note the fact that with AMP, third-party JavaScript isn't permitted.

(3) AMP CDN – This is an optional Content Delivery Network. Taking your AMP-enabled pages, it will cache them and also automatically make some performance optimizations.



How to AMP a site?

To begin with, a minimum of two versions of any article page must be maintained. These include the original article version which a user will usually see-the other being the AMP version of the same page.

AMP does not allow such things as third-party JavaScript and form elements. Therefore, you probably won't be able to have such used-to elements on standard implementation of your page like on-page comments and lead forms. Also, it's imperative that you rewrite the site template so that you can accommodate the restrictions. It should be less than 50KB. Another factor is that because of loading-intensiveness of custom fonts they have to be loaded with a special amp-font extension: this is so that there's a better control over the loading.

Then, there's multimedia which must also be handled specially. An example with images is that they will need the custom amp-img element and also must have width and height explicitly mentioned. Point to note here is that you can expect hassles while converting a legacy website into